

Kexing Yan

Toronto, Ontario, Canada · ykx050915@gmail.com
kexingyan.com · linkedin.com/in/kexing-yan · github.com/KexingYan

EDUCATION

University of Toronto, St. George Campus

2024 – 2028 (expected)

Honours Bachelor of Science — Double Major in Economics and Statistics, Focus in Data Analytics

Relevant coursework: Econometrics, Statistical Methods, Regression Analysis, Data Analysis, Microeconomic Theory, Macroeconomic Theory, Introduction to Computer Programming

RESEARCH

The Quantity and Size of Microloans Follow Different Development Logics: Evidence from Kiva

2026

Working paper, sole author — extends a term research project, University of Toronto · kexingyan.com/papers

- Assembled a 357-observation country-year panel covering 84 countries over 2013–2017, built from more than one million loan-level Kiva records merged with World Bank macroeconomic indicators and institutional quality measures.
- Separated microfinance activity into three distinct outcomes — total lending volume, average loan size, and whether Kiva operates in a country at all — and showed that each relates to development level through a different mechanism.
- Estimated PPML models for lending volume, which accommodates zero outcomes and heteroskedasticity in a multiplicative specification, and Logit models for country entry, reported as average marginal effects rather than raw coefficients.
- Applied the Lind–Mehlum test to formally evaluate turning points instead of relying on the sign of a squared term: loan size follows a significant U-shape, while total lending volume shows no significant inverted-U, contrary to the middle-income peak commonly assumed in the microfinance literature.
- Clustered standard errors at the country level and validated results across alternative specifications, subsamples, and functional forms; constructed an institutional quality index via principal component analysis for use as a moderating variable.
- Built the full pipeline in Python (pandas, NumPy, statsmodels, matplotlib) as a reproducible Jupyter and Git workflow, with the manuscript typeset in LaTeX.

SKILLS

Programming & tools — Python (pandas, NumPy, statsmodels, matplotlib, scikit-learn); SQL (querying, filtering, aggregation, multi-table joins); R; Excel; Git and GitHub; Jupyter; LaTeX

Econometrics — Panel data construction and estimation; OLS and PPML; binary choice models (Logit, average marginal effects); interaction and quadratic specifications; turning-point testing (Lind–Mehlum); clustered standard errors; robustness and specification checks

Statistics — Exploratory data analysis; principal component analysis; hypothesis testing and statistical inference; large-scale data cleaning and cross-database merging

Applied areas — Development economics, financial markets, macroeconomic data

Languages — English (fluent); Mandarin Chinese (native)

HONOURS

University of Toronto Entrance Scholarship

2024

Merit-based award granted on admission in recognition of academic standing.

ACADEMIC INVOLVEMENT

CFA Institute — Online Economics and Finance Seminars

2024 – present

Participant

Sessions on macroeconomic trends, financial markets, and investment analysis.